

Case Study Title	Case Study Description
Addressing Maternal and Infant Mortality in Meghalaya by Building State Capability	The case centres on the dilemma faced by Sampath Kumar, Principal Secretary of Health in the northeastern state of Meghalaya, as he strives to reduce the high maternal and infant mortality rates in the region. To address the issue, Kumar implemented a variety of measures, including the use of data and technology for real-time monitoring of high-risk pregnancies, centralising decision-making at the frontline worker level, enhancing communication between citizens and the state, fostering cross-functional problem-solving among government departments, building political support, and addressing systemic gaps. These efforts resulted in significant progress. However, to fully resolve the challenge, Kumar also needed to address broader societal issues, such as teenage pregnancies and the lack of family planning.
Ayushman Bharat - Healthy India for Universal Health Coverage	The case centers on a scheme to expand access to primary health care services under the Indian central government's flagship Ayushman Bharat program, a national public health insurance initiative. The scheme aimed to establish 1.5 lakh Health and Wellness Centers across India to provide free and universal comprehensive primary health care. These centers would offer a wide range of services, including health and wellness services, maternal and child health services, treatment for non-communicable diseases, palliative and rehabilitative care, oral, eye, ENT, mental health, elderly care, and emergency and trauma care. The program manager encountered several challenges in implementing this ambitious project. Key obstacles included obtaining approval to recruit a new cadre of officers, namely Community Health Officers, to serve in these centers. Additionally, there were significant efforts required in capacity building and training these officers and other primary health service personnel, as well as monitoring the performance and effectiveness of these centers.
Jeevika – Didi Ki Rasoi	This case focuses on JEEViKA, Bihar's Rural Livelihoods Promotion Society, an initiative aimed at organizing economically marginalized women in the state into self-help groups. These groups empower women to seek employment opportunities and access funding. One notable program conceptualized under JEEViKA is the "Didi ki Rasoi" initiative. Through this program, local women establish institutional canteens at state hospitals, schools, and other community centers to provide fresh, home-cooked healthy meals. This initiative addresses the issue of poor food quality in these institutions while simultaneously generating employment and income for the women involved.
Mission Youth: A Journey to Empowerment	The case revolves around Dr. Shahid Iqbal Choudhary, an IAS Officer in Jammu and Kashmir, who faces the challenge of high youth unemployment and disenfranchisement in the state. In response, Dr. Shahid launched the Mission Youth initiative in March 2021 with the goal of transforming the state's youth into ambassadors of peace, prosperity, and development. This initiative included a series of interventions aimed at improving employment, empowerment, and engagement among the youth, securing Rs. 200 crores in state funds for the program. The program was a resounding success, resulting in a significant increase in job creation and youth engagement.
En Uru – The Tribal Heritage Village of Wayanad	The case is situated in Wayanad, a Northern district in the state of Kerala, where the scheduled tribe (ST) community comprises a high share of the local population, yet is economically marginalised. The local officer in charge, Mr. Nair, comes up with an innovative way to generate income for the state while also uplifting the members of the local tribal community. He comes up with the idea of setting up En Uru – a model heritage village – a tourist site in which tribes can be employed while generating revenues for themselves and the district. He puts in place training programs to ensure that ST members are able to contribute to the project.
Risk mitigation in public infrastructure projects: The case of Rewa Solar Power Plant	The Rewa Solar Project (RUMSL) case offers an authoritative example of public-private partnerships in India and helps discern how risk can be mitigated to ensure the success of a PPP model. An innovation by IAS Manu Srivastava, Rewa was financed in a way to ensure that the project did not rely on viable gap funding (VGF), offered by the Government of India while attracting procurers. RUMSL was commissioned on January 3, 2020, and was formally dedicated to the nation by Prime Minister, Mr Narendra Modi, on July 10, 2020. However, right from the beginning, Manu Srivastava faced a spectrum of challenges such as identifying donors, maintaining an attractive tariff rate without VGF, acquiring land, and identifying procurers. By studying these challenges and the solutions adopted by Manu Srivastava, learners can learn the innovative ways through which risk can be mitigated in a large project such as RUMSL.

Mainstreaming renewable energy: The case of Rewa Solar Rooftop Installation Project	The Madhya Pradesh solar rooftop installation case is a good example to illustrate how to make a project an attractive proposition for key stakeholders. The case can help us understand how de-risking a project, addressing information asymmetry, mitigating risks, and ensuring transparency in the project cycle drives increased and informed participation. The case unfolds against the challenge of increasing solar rooftop installations to meet the state's solar energy production targets under the National Solar Mission. Mr Manu Srivastava, head of Madhya Pradesh Urja Vikas Nigam Limited, is tasked with resolving the puzzle of why uptake is low despite incentives offered by the government. Through addressing key stakeholder concerns, efficient project structuring, and process innovations in a market-based financing model, the climate agenda is taken forward.
Enabling inclusive governance: The case of Rail Divyang Saarthi	The development and implementation of Rail Divyang Saarthi application by the Ahmedabad Division of Western Railways is a good case to discuss embedding technology into policy solutions effectively for People with Disabilities (PwD). The app helped significantly reduce the number of days applicants had to wait to receive their railway concession cards. Accessibility and inclusion are the principles that resurface throughout this story. It demonstrates how technology is not a one-stop solution and how its effectiveness goes hand-in-hand with clarity in policies, inter-departmental coordination and communication. The app helped significantly reduce the number of days applicants had to wait to receive their railway concession cards.
Innovative grievance redressal: The case of the RailMadad app	The Rail Madad Application of Indian Railways is a good case to discuss principles of decentralisation and transparency in large-scale grievance redressal systems. It uses a passenger or benefactor-centric model to achieve maximum customer satisfaction. To create this system, they focus on a bottom-up approach with room for levels of escalation, ensuring speedy service delivery while maintaining full transparency across the board. Rail Madad is the brainchild of Vivek Srivastava, the protagonist of the innovation. Soon after joining the commercial department of Rail Bhawan in New Delhi, Srivastava discovered that the many channels of communication established by divisions across the country were not standardised or centralised to provide real-time grievance redressal for the passengers. He led his team to create a singular platform, Rail Madad, that connected passengers to the last-mile service delivery staff to offer real-time problem resolution while offering full transparency to all stakeholders.
Leveraging AI for Security: The case of ASTR	The ASTR case illustrates the administrative and ethical complexities of employing AI-based facial recognition powered solutions for governance. The case unfolds against terrorism concerns in J&K in 2021. Around the same time, the Department of Telecommunications (DoT) under Mr. Naveen Jakhar was working on addressing the increase in cybercrime in Mewat, Haryana, due to the issue of SIM cards based on fake identities. The use of fake SIM cards is leveraged to propose a solution based on adopting AI-based facial recognition technology to identify fake SIM cards. The case can help us understand how an ecosystem could be developed, to facilitate the smooth interaction of stakeholders needed to incorporate facial recognition technology in governance.
Balancing economic growth and sustainable ecotourism: The case of Dhar Nature Retreat and Awareness Camp	The 'Nature Retreat and Awareness Camp' – an ecotourism project in Chamrod, Dhar Kalan in Punjab – is a good case to discuss the principles of participatory natural resource management. The relevant principles include understanding natural resources management mechanism, biodiversity of the ecosystem, livelihood strategies sustained by the ecosystem, and participatory environmental governance. The case set between 2017 and to present day in Chamrod, Dhar Kalan in Punjab was developed in 2017 where Dr Sanjeev Kumar, the protagonist undertakes the task of efficiently using the barren land near the Ranjit Sagar Lake to help bring about economic development in the Dhar Kalan's villages. Being cognizant of the fact that such ecotourism camp in an ecologically sensitive zone requires a scientific approach, careful planning and participatory support from local residents to assure the sustainability of the ecosystem. Conserving Dhar forest's flora and fauna and spreading awareness about green living to people residing were essential elements to the project's development.

Capacity building in Southern Railway: The case of the IT Cell initiative	The establishment of an IT Cell in the Chief Commercial Manager (Passenger) office in the Southern Railways is an ideal case to discuss principles of optimal utilisation of limited resources in team building. Relevant principles include capacity building through continuous guided learning, adaptive management through the institutionalisation of innovation, committed leadership and responsive governance. The case is set in December 2017 when Mr. Vinayan was appointed as the Chief Commercial Manager (Passenger) of Southern Railways, headquartered in Chennai. With decades of experience in Southern Railways, Mr. Vinayan is aware of challenges that affect the efficiency of the system for both its employees and passengers. He knows that the solutions to these challenges can be through technological development, but he does not want to outsource the work to external agencies and become dependent on their service. He undertakes the charge to address these challenges internally by developing an IT Cell, using old resources that already exist and harnessing those lying dormant.
Adopting an ecosystem approach to groundwater recharging: Pond rejuvenation project in Udham Singh Nagar	The pond rejuvenation project in Udham Singh Nagar, Uttarakhand is a good case to discuss the principles of applying an ecosystem approach to governance. Relevant principles include focusing on relationships and processes within the ecosystem of key players' economic and political activity, benefit-sharing, adaptive and responsive management, including change management practices, appropriate decentralisation of tasks and responsibilities, and intersectoral cooperation. The case is set between 2019 and present-day Udham Singh Nagar, Uttarakhand, where Mayur Dixit, the protagonist, undertakes the task of rejuvenating ponds that have been encroached upon to recharge the district's groundwater table. Apart from hydrogeological reasons, Udham Singh Nagar, a district located in Uttarakhand's Terai region, is on the verge of a general water crisis resulting from water-intensive farming and rampant industrialisation. Mayur Dixit is aware of the limits of simply recharging ponds via desilting and other conventional pond rejuvenation methods. He understands the need to develop a holistic approach that takes into account the underlying causes of the lowered groundwater levels.
Combating the Covid-19 Pandemic in India	The Har Ghar Tikakaran campaign is centred on the remarkable efforts of Dr. Veena Dhawan and her dedicated team, who spearheaded one of the largest vaccination drives ever conducted in India - the National Covid-19 Vaccination Program, amidst the throes of a pandemic. This campaign reflects upon the myriad challenges and obstacles encountered by the team and illuminates their triumphant journey in surmounting these hurdles through unwavering unity, unyielding determination, and exemplary cooperation.
Improving Revenue Department performance through LAKSHYAM	In rural India, Lekhpals are crucial in safeguarding property rights and facilitating various administrative tasks. Despite their significance, there has been a lack of an objective performance management system to track their effectiveness. This deficiency hinders the government's ability to identify strong performers, support those needing improvement, and ensure accountability. To address this, UP Govt. developed a comprehensive performance management system named LAKSHYAM (Lekhpals Actionable KPI System for Holistic Assessment and Management) and piloted it in Prayagraj. LAKSHYAM operates on three pillars: Objective KPIs, Direct Supervisor Feedback, and Stakeholders & Feedback.
Operation Parivartan: Societal change through transformational leadership	Ms. Tejaswi Satpute, Mumbai's Deputy Commissioner of Police spearheaded Operation Parivartan, targeting the long-standing issue of illicit liquor consumption in Solapur, rooted in illegal brewing and hazardous ingredients. Facing challenges in conventional raids, Ms. Tejaswi adopted a scientific strategy to address the entire brewing cycle, aiming to disrupt the production and distribution of illicit liquor. The 72-hour brewing cycle was a critical focus, requiring post-raid actions for a lasting solution. Her dedication to ethical principles in public service guided her efforts to combat the multifaceted issues associated with the illicit liquor trade.

Addressing Maternal and Infant Mortality in Meghalaya by Building State Capability	Kathirimalai, a remote tribal hamlet in Erode district of Tamil Nadu, was inaccessible due to its location on a high mountain top in the Bargur Hills and deep within the Channampatti forest reserve. Also, home to 400 members of the Sholaga tribe, these inhabitants of Kathirimalai Village needed to travel several hours along a rough trail and through the forest to access medical facilities at the nearest primary health centre. Severe malnutrition, stunting, and communicable diseases were prevalent among these tribals as they mostly avoided visiting the medical centre for regular health reviews. Even the availability of educational facilities in a single-teacher local school was minimal. Poor learning outcomes and absenteeism among school-going children was common. A young IAS officer, Mr. Krishnanunni led a coordinated effort under Project Punnagai (Project Smile) to transform this hamlet. The Wi-Fi facility, set up in the school premises, essentially to establish telemedicine facilities in Kathirimalai was used as a convergence platform to bring other facilities to the community viz., learning resources for improving education, skill development programs for enhancing employability of youth, livelihood enhancement by better agriculture and animal rearing practices. Today Project Punnagai is being replicated across multiple villages of Tamil Nadu.
Initiative for Digitalization of Land Information (IDLI) at Delhi Development Authority	The Delhi Development Authority (DDA), as a regulatory body, is responsible for the management of land resources under the Master Plan for Delhi, India's capital city. It controls the planning, acquisition, development, and allotment of land for private, public, and government needs. Following his appointment as Commissioner (Land Disposal), Mr. Subu recognised an urgent need to develop a digital information system for the effective processing and management of land records and activities. Previous efforts by DDA to implement digitalisation through data outsourcing to leading software development companies had failed and tracking documents was difficult. Mr. Subu initiated the development of the information system named Initiative for Digitalisation of Land Information (IDLI), which is an online cloud-managed information system for the workflow of land-related activities. It provides transparency and improved turnaround time for service delivery.
Leadership Interventions and Succession Planning at Hindustan Petroleum Corporation Limited	The case highlights the positive impacts of Leadership Intervention and Succession Planning at HPCL through Various Strategies- T20 Strategy, T25 Strategy, HP Possible Model. All these interventions were focused on identifying, training and skilling the potential leaders in the company for a smooth succession and seamless working of the company.
Leaving No One Behind: Leveraging the Power of Collaboration to Vaccinate the Most Vulnerable	The Chikkaballapur district administration in Karnataka was working hard to scale up COVID-19 vaccinations, but without much success. Under the leadership of Dr. C.N. Satyanarayana Reddy, Taluka Health Officer of Chikkaballapur district, strategic collaborations were initiated to accelerate vaccinations for the most vulnerable populations across India in line with the government's mandate of leaving no one behind. Following an understanding of the causes underlying vaccine resistance and implementation challenges in the district, appropriate measures were undertaken to raise awareness and design effective vaccine delivery systems.
New Age Learning Centre- Transforming the lives of the students of Changlang	NALC is a Free of Cost Service which enables flexible, state of the art, futuristic and leisure learning space which enables people from all age groups to learn and improve every aspect of their personality through free Wi-Fi (24x7), online training through tablets, e-reading through kindle, etc, in an environment furnished with modular furniture. It converges resources that are rendered unused viz. libraries of government schools are marred with a lack of dedicated library teachers, library infrastructure and books and transforms these existing libraries into NALC helping in optimum utilisation of unused resources of libraries run by the library department which acts as cluster libraries for nearby schools wherein children from all schools may access this space as their library.

Bikes of Bijnor: A waste to wealth public bike sharing programme	This case documents the innovative and collaborative efforts by the Bijnor administration to create wealth from the bicycles—abandoned by the migrant workers during the COVID-19 pandemic—to birth the inclusive Bikes of Bijnor ride-sharing program. The bicycles left as a heap of iron waste outside the police stations of Bijnor in Uttar Pradesh were utilised in the ridesharing program with significant social and environmental benefit. Under the program, the bicycle owners were first identified and then compensated to obtain legal possession of the bicycles. Bicycles were then refurbished, and bike stands were set up at 10 spots in Bijnor town. The bicycles were then made available for hire at a minimal cost. The ridesharing program—the brainchild of the Bijnor Joint Magistrate, Mr. Vikramaditya Singh Malik, in 2020-21—brought together the civil service and the municipal administration. Both collaborated to fund the project and formally registered “Bikes of Bijnor” as a society headed by the Sub-divisional Magistrate (SDM) Sadar, while the Head and the Executive Officer of the Nagar Palika functioned as its secretary.
SOTTO: Transforming Lives through Organ Transplantation in Gujarat	In the heart of Gujarat, the transformative impact of cadaver organ transplantation unfolds through powerful narratives. These stories highlight the profound effect of the State Organ and Tissue Transplantation Organisation (SOTTO), established in 2019 to revolutionise cadaver organ procurement and transplantation across government and private hospitals. Guided by rigorous protocols and the 2020 Brain Stem Death Declaration guidelines, SOTTO ensures ethical and efficient practices. Its online platform, launched in May 2020, enhances transparency and coordination, matching organs with recipients to maximise life-saving impacts. These efforts underscore Gujarat's commitment to fostering a sustainable healthcare ecosystem through the generosity of donors, breathing hope and life into countless individuals.
Andhra Pradesh Pioneers Energy Demand Forecasting Using Artificial Intelligence/Machine Learning Techniques	The case revolves around Andhra Pradesh Transmission Corporation (APTransco) efforts to advance India's electricity grid management with the introduction of the country's inaugural AI-driven day-ahead electricity forecasting model. This innovation predicts electricity consumption and demand in precise 15-minute intervals, thus optimises grid operations, minimising costs, and extends its forecasting capabilities to include wind, solar energy, and market prices. With an aim to establish a low-cost dispatch model for electricity generation, APTransco underlines its commitment to efficient grid management.
Vehicle Tracking to Ensure Cradle to Grave Disposal of Hazardous Waste in Gujarat	The Gujarat Pollution Control Board (GPCB) launched an innovative Vehicle Location Tracking System (VLTS) developed in collaboration with NIC Gujarat and NIC Uttarakhand to enhance the monitoring and management of hazardous waste transportation. This project aims to ensure the safe and compliant movement of hazardous materials by leveraging advanced GPS technology, real-time tracking, and robust data analytics. By implementing the VLTS, GPCB seeks to mitigate environmental risks, improve regulatory oversight and promote sustainable waste management practices across the state. This case study delves into the technical aspects, implementation challenges and anticipated benefits of this groundbreaking initiative, underscoring its potential to set new standards in environmental regulation.
Socio- and Techno-Economic Upliftment of Tribal Population with Bioresource-Based Entrepreneurship: A Case Study from Arunachal Pradesh	Dr. Debajit Mahanta and his team, aimed at uplifting the socio-economic status of the tribal population through bioresource-based entrepreneurship. Leveraging the state's rich biodiversity, the CoE, supported by various national and international institutions, focuses on research, innovation, and capacity building to create sustainable livelihoods and promote economic growth. It addresses challenges like unemployment and limited market access, striving to preserve cultural identity while adapting to modern advancements. The initiative exemplifies a holistic approach to biodiversity conservation, sustainable development, and techno-economic empowerment, aspiring to serve as a model for the entire Northeast region of the country.

Developing a Sports Ecosystem in Odisha: The Role of Private Public Partnerships	In the past few years, Odisha has emerged as a hub for sporting activities in India. It has hosted international sporting events such as the Asian Athletics Championship (2017) and two hockey World Cups (2018 and 2023), besides having built the largest seated hockey stadium in the world and laid 22 artificial hockey turfs in a single district. By the end of 2023, Odisha had 90 multi-purpose indoor stadiums, 25 hockey training centres, 314 rural mini stadiums and 149 urban mini stadiums . During the same period, there was a significant increase in Odisha state's representation in national and international sports events, improvement in athlete performance besides large-scale participation from the grassroots in numerous sports disciplines. Odisha's transformation as a leader in sports was led by a multitude of factors such as an inspired and involved leadership, a committed bureaucracy and a well-orchestrated public-private partnership that complemented each other. This case study covers in depth how multitude actors from diverse organisations and institutions came together to create an ecosystem of sporting excellence in Odisha, which has hitherto never been seen in India.
Land Resource Inventory Boosts Farm Yields in Karnataka	The Land Resource Inventory (LRI) was developed as a new approach to enhance the impact of the watershed programme. It is an inventory of five physical factors—rock, soil, slope, erosion type and severity and vegetation—which form the basis for assessing land resources. The Land Resource Inventory (LRI) technology—developed under Sujala III in 2013-14 and implemented in 11 districts—empowers farmers with site-specific information to make crop choices and boost farm incomes. It was designed for execution through a consortium of partners to develop a site-specific land resource database through use of state-of-the-art remote sensing (RS) and geographic information systems for data collection and interpretation. A Land Resources Portal for information dissemination was then established by developing a digital library through pooling all the spatial and non-spatial data, containing both site-specific farm information and generalised data about land. A mobile application was developed to enable farmers to access the LRI portal. The Watershed Development Department (WDD) of the Karnataka state government spearheaded the project.
GST: The Story of India's biggest tax reform	The case explores how the multiple stakeholders in the GST project were finally able to work together to implement GST. How is consensus built when so many parties are involved? How are the diverse interests of these stakeholders safeguarded in the process? The case also examines the complexities of the Indian taxation system pre-GST and thus, delves into the inherent consequent complexity of such a massive tax reform as GST. How did the centre get the states on board with the idea of GST? How was a rapport of trust and understanding established between the centre and the states? Finally, the case looks briefly at the challenge of bringing a new technology-driven system into a nation that was just beginning to accustom itself to the concept of digitalization. The case explores how all these factors tied in to making GST possible, and a major success, at that.
Implementation of Poshan Abhiyaan in Kokrajhar district, Assam	This case study highlights the innovative approach of Ms. Varnali Dekha in addressing nutrition-related challenges faced by children in Kokrajhar district, Assam. Under the broader “Poshan” initiative, Ms. Dekha employs a multifaceted six-pronged strategy designed to tackle these issues comprehensively. Her approach integrates various creative interventions aimed at improving nutritional outcomes, enhancing community awareness, and fostering sustainable practices. Through this case study, we explore the effectiveness of her strategies and their impact on the well-being of children in the region, providing valuable insights into the practical application of targeted nutritional interventions.
Chandrayaan 3	This case explores the Indian Space Research Organisation's (ISRO) landmark achievement with Chandrayaan-3, which made India the first country to land near the lunar South Pole on August 23, 2023. It highlights the strategic leadership, structured failure analysis, and risk management that defined the mission — along with ISRO's hallmark strengths in cost-effective innovation, organizational culture, and a balanced approach to collaboration and self-reliance. The case offers insights into how ISRO's inclusive, learning-driven ecosystem enabled a bold leap in space exploration, setting the stage for even more ambitious missions ahead.

Raj Kisaan Saathi	India's agriculture sector continues to be a mainstay of the country's economy, supporting millions of livelihoods and is the backbone of rural development. Despite its importance, the sector continues to be plagued by poor public investments, limited access and uptake of technology, and outdated practices. The Raj Kisan Sathi Portal is a novel effort by the Government of Rajasthan to modernise agricultural practices in the state using IT solutions. Initiated in 2019, the portal simplifies farming processes, provides vital information, and improves service delivery for farmers. In this policy and technology integration case, students will learn about the design, implementation, and challenges associated with executing and scaling a state-wide initiative. Studying this initiative offers valuable insights into leveraging technology to address systemic challenges in the agricultural sector to improve efficiency and social equity.
PM SVANidhi – Turning Adversity into Opportunity through e-Governance	The PM SVANidhi Scheme has emerged as a catalyst for inclusive urban entrepreneurship, breaking barriers that previously limited access for marginalized micro-entrepreneurs. With a notable rise in female participation, the scheme has advanced women's entrepreneurial empowerment, contributing to broader gender equality in urban markets. PM SVANidhi has strengthened the sustainability of small urban businesses. This caselet explores the scheme's implementation, the challenges faced in reaching its objectives and outlines the path ahead to further enhance its role in fostering resilient and inclusive urban livelihoods.
Udyam Assist Platform – A Key Differentiator for Informal Micro Enterprises (IMEs)	Micro enterprises play a critical role in India's economy, contributing to GDP, exports, and job creation. However, over 99% operate informally, limiting access to finance and government benefits. To address this, the Ministry of MSME launched Udyam Registration in 2020, but many informal micro enterprises (IMEs) remained unregistered due to lack of awareness, documents, and digital skills. To bridge this gap, the Ministry introduced the Udyam Assist Platform (UAP) on January 11, 2023, developed and managed by SIDBI. Unlike the self-registration Udyam Registration Portal, UAP enables banks and microfinance institutions to register IMEs on their behalf, using Aadhaar-based verification and bulk data uploads. The platform enhances reach, ensures data security, and issues an Udyam Assist Certificate, allowing IMEs to later self-register fully.
PM PVTG	The Pradhan Mantri PVTG Mission, a flagship program of the Indian Government, is dedicated to enhance the socio-economic conditions of the Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups (PVTGs) in the country. This case delves into the assessment and resolution of challenges faced by the mission, which has been allocated a budget of Rs. 15,000 crore over three years, commencing in 2023-24. The mission aims to provide critical support in the form of housing, water, sanitation, education, healthcare, and livelihood opportunities, while respecting the cultural integrity of PVTGs. This case offers a comprehensive understanding of the issues faced by PVTGs, and the effectiveness of the mission in addressing these concerns, aligning with broader governmental objectives in accordance with United Nation's Sustainable Development Goals (UNSDGs). The case encourages adoption of an empathetic approach and devising of impact-oriented execution strategies.
Third Party Inspection	On April 25, 2022, Mr. Arun Mehta, Principal Chief Materials Manager of Western Railways, launched a transformative Third-Party Inspection (TPI) initiative to modernize quality assurance in Indian Railways. The program aimed to enhance efficiency, build capacity, and create a competitive inspection ecosystem focused on quality over cost. Presented to top Railway Board officials, it received strong support from the Chairman, Member Finance, and RDSO. On May 8, 2022, the Board authorized Western Railway to engage private TPI agencies for 2–3 years. Tasked with designing the empanelment system, Mr. Mehta sought to integrate private efficiencies without disrupting inspections while reflecting on fairness and possible stakeholder conflicts.
The Hunt for Benami Property: A Data-Driven Approach to Financial Investigation	A retired senior civil servant, living a quiet post-service life, drew attention when the Benami Unit in Delhi spotted unusual property records. Quiet checks began—silent, precise, unnoticed. Clues pointed to hidden wealth. A secret search was planned across four cities. When the Income Tax teams struck, they uncovered a web of unreported assets and benami properties worth over ₹240 crores. Behind the calm facade lay a story of evasion—now exposed.
Institutionalizing Community Engagement to Tackle Malnutrition: A Case Study of the Tithi Bhojan Initiative	This case study explores the institutionalization of Tithi Bhojan under the PM POSHAN scheme as a model of community-led action to address child malnutrition. It highlights the shift from government-led service delivery to community-enabled participation, examining how diverse stakeholders collaborate to integrate the initiative into policy. The case raises key questions about sustaining community engagement, building multi-stakeholder partnerships, and embedding participatory governance in public nutrition programs for long-term impact.

Ticket to Transformation: Digitalizing Human Resources in Indian Railways	This case explores the ambitious digital transformation of the Human Resources function in Indian Railways, one of the largest public sector employers in the world. It follows the shift from a manual, paper-based system to an integrated Human Resource Management System (HRMS) developed by CRIS, the IT arm of Indian Railways. The case outlines why the change was needed, how it was implemented, and the challenges faced along the way, from managing legacy data and ensuring cybersecurity to handling change in a hierarchical system. It also touches on stakeholder engagement, training, and the wider impact of digitisation in government. This is a story of transforming scale with strategy, and legacy with leadership.
Defeating the Black Fever: India's strategic win against Kala-azar	India's long-standing battle against Kala-azar persisted despite substantial resources and strategic programmes under NKEP. In 2021, Mr. Rajiv Manjhi identified that program success hinged on behavioural change and direct community involvement. Through innovative, locally adapted solutions—such as mud-house crack sealing, intensified surveillance, targeted vector management, health worker training, and rural evening awareness sessions—the programme enhanced effectiveness and public engagement. These measures significantly strengthened disease control efforts and marked a pivotal shift toward achieving national Kala-azar elimination.
Transforming Housing in Ganori through PM Awaas Yojana	This case study showcases the transformation of 20 Scheduled Tribe families in Ganori Gram Panchayat who, after years of living in forest encroachments without housing rights, gained secure homes through collective action. Led by Sarpanch Mrs. Saralataai Tandale, with support from the Block Development Officer, DRDA Project Director Ms. Sangeetadevi Patil, and others, land was purchased under the Pandit Dindayal Upadhyay Gharkul Scheme. Villager Mr. Dadasaheb Jadhav sold 20 gunthas at a fair rate, and Ms. Anuradha Chavan covered registration costs. Using MGNREGA labour, houses were built with sanitation, LPG, and tap water under national schemes. The initiative demonstrates how convergence between local leadership and administration fosters inclusion, dignity, and lasting empowerment.
The ORMAS Model: Leveraging Community Cadres for Rural Youth Engagement in Odisha	Odisha revitalized India's flagship skill development program, DDU-GKY, which initially struggled with low enrolment, weak awareness, and high dropouts. The Odisha Rural Development and Marketing Society (ORMAS) introduced a structured mobilization model by incentivizing Community Cadres (Gram Rojgar Sevaks, Community Resource Persons, Master Book Keepers) and using mobilisation camps, IEC tools, and community engagement. This approach boosted enrolment, improved training outcomes, and enhanced job retention, demonstrating how community-driven strategies can make national missions more effective.
Women-led Entrepreneurship and Empowerment: Impact of Mission Shakti in Odisha	The case study examines the impact of Mission Shakti, a government initiative launched in Odisha, India, to promote women-led entrepreneurship and empowerment. The programme has enabled women to engage in income-generating activities, access financial services, and build leadership skills. It has strengthened women's self-help groups (SHGs) through capacity building, skill development, and financial inclusion. Mission Shakti has empowered women to start and scale businesses, boosting their confidence, financial independence, and participation in social and political spheres. It further emphasizes the importance of community support, policy backing, and sustainable practices in ensuring long-term success, positioning Mission Shakti as a potential model for broader replication.
Integrating Tradition and Innovation: The Asomi Pearl Farming Story	The Asomi Pearl Farming Project in Nagaon, Assam, demonstrates how grassroots innovation can enhance rural livelihoods by integrating freshwater pearl cultivation with traditional aquaculture, creating additional income streams and environmental benefits. Despite technical and market challenges, the initiative succeeded through skill development, cooperative financial support, and buy-back assurances. With the global pearl market exceeding USD 10.5 billion and India's presence still limited, the project highlights Assam's potential to become a key player in global pearl value chains. Scaling the model will require advanced training, improved grafting techniques, stronger cooperative governance, branding, and policy-backed market linkages, enabling its transformation into a sustainable, market-driven rural enterprise that strengthens economic resilience.

India's Dam Safety Act: From Risk to Regulation	India, home to over 6,000 large dams—many aging and vulnerable—faced longstanding challenges in ensuring dam safety due to fragmented practices and federal complexities. The 1979 Machchhu-2 dam disaster underscored the urgency, but legislative efforts stalled for decades. The Dam Safety Act, 2021 marks a historic shift by establishing a uniform, legally binding framework for dam safety across India. Overcoming constitutional hurdles, inter-state tensions, and institutional inertia, the Act was enabled by sustained bureaucratic advocacy, legal innovation, and broad stakeholder engagement. Key features include a four-tier safety structure, mandatory inspections, real-time monitoring, and clear accountability mechanisms—balancing national oversight with state autonomy. This case highlights how long-term reform is possible through persistence, adaptive policymaking, and cooperative federalism. It offers lessons for future legislation involving complex governance and public safety systems.
From Crisis to Championing: The Story of Farm Loan Waiver in Maharashtra	This case presents the policy design and implementation journey of MJPSKY, Maharashtra's flagship farm loan waiver scheme (2019–20), crafted in response to the operational failures of an earlier waiver (CSMSSY, 2017). The case offers a comparative study of two state-led interventions and explores themes of administrative reform, welfare technology, crisis management, and institutional accountability. It highlights how political pressure, ground-level feedback, and adaptive leadership led to a redesign of scheme architecture using a reverse-verification model, phased rollout, direct government control of IT systems, and behavioral incentives for credit discipline. Ideal for discussions on governance, public policy delivery, and state capacity, the case encourages reflection on moral hazard in welfare, regional disparities in implementation, and the limits of financial relief as a standalone response to agrarian distress.
Anchoring Global Efficiency: Visakhapatnam Leads India's Entry into the World's Top 20 Container Ports	This case study examines how Visakhapatnam Port Authority (VPA) achieved a remarkable turnaround by entering the World Bank's Global Top 20 Container Port Performance Index (CPPI) in 2024, rising from rank 115 to 19 within a year. Located strategically on India's eastern seaboard near the Malacca Strait, VPA leveraged strong rail-road connectivity to strengthen its competitive position. The transformation was led by Chairperson Dr. M. Angamuthu, appointed in May 2023, at a time when the port faced ageing infrastructure, procedural delays, and intense competition from private ports. Using the autonomy provided by the Major Port Authorities Act, 2021, the leadership implemented reforms focused on operational efficiency, digitalization, and stakeholder coordination. A long-standing PPP with Visakha Container Terminal Pvt. Ltd., along with ecosystem-wide collaboration, enabled capacity upgrades, improved turnaround times, and greater environmental sustainability.
The DigiYatra Initiative: Harnessing Technology for Hassle Free Air Travel	In Dec 2022, the Government of India launched the Digi Yatra initiative at three airports (Delhi, Bengaluru, Varanasi)—a first-of-its-kind digital transformation program that aimed to streamline air travel processes and enhance passenger experiences at airports across the country. The program aimed to eliminate long queues, reduce paperwork, and improve security checks by leveraging biometric technology and digital identification. The Airports Authority of India (AAI), along with other airport operators, took on the task of implementing this ambitious project. Starting with three airports, the government rolled out the initiative in a phased manner, and by the end of 2024, it had implemented Digi Yatra across various airports in the country, significantly improving passenger convenience and operational efficiency.
Reviving Ordnance Factory Balangir: Strategic Shifts in Defence Manufacturing	In a landmark reform, the Government of India restructured the century-old Ordnance Factory Board (OFB) into seven Defence Public Sector Undertakings (DPSUs) on October 1, 2021, to tackle longstanding inefficiencies in defence production. Triggered by repeated CAG reports and expert committee recommendations, the move aimed to improve agility, accountability, and responsiveness to the Armed Forces' needs. Within this transformation, the Chief General Manager of Ordnance Factory Balangir (OFBL), Shri P.K. Dash, faces a key challenge: enhancing output without compromising on quality or safety, requiring strategic, balanced decision-making.
PARAM Shavak: India's Indigenous Answer to High Performance Computing	PARAM Shavak is an indigenous high-performance computing (HPC) desktop system developed under the National Supercomputing Mission by CDAC, MeitY, and VVDN Technologies. Powered by Rudra, it represents a major step forward in making advanced supercomputing accessible to academic and research institutions across India. Compact, energy-efficient, and cost-effective, PARAM Shavak enables institutions with limited resources to undertake cutting-edge research. By democratizing access to HPC, it helps overcome challenges such as low awareness, funding limitations, and a shortage of skilled professionals. This case study explores the system's development, implementation challenges, and its contribution to strengthening India's research ecosystem and advancing digital transformation.

Bridging the Last Mile: Nidhi Aapke Nikat 2.0 and the Quest for Human Centric Governance	This case explores how the Employees' Provident Fund Organisation transformed service delivery through Nidhi Aapke Nikat 2.0, a decentralised, human-centred outreach model that brings services to remote districts, resolves grievances on the spot, and builds trust through direct engagement. As the programme effectively reaches citizens often excluded from digital reforms, EPFO now faces a strategic challenge: sustaining this high-touch model while meeting pressures for digital scale, automation, and cost efficiency. The case highlights the governance trade-offs between AI-enabled systems and personalised interfaces to ensure inclusion.
Integrated Command and Control Centre: A Holistic Approach to Tackling Environmental Challenges in Chandigarh, India	Chandigarh's ICCC was conceived to combat growing environmental issues such as air pollution, traffic congestion, water scarcity, and poor waste management. With strong leadership and support under the Smart Cities Mission, the city implemented a technology-driven, data-integrated command center to monitor and optimize urban operations across 25+ services. It evolved through four phases: planning, infrastructure development, real-time integration, and community engagement. The case presents both achievements and challenges—ranging from institutional resistance, financial limitations, and privacy concerns to remarkable successes in traffic management, pollution control, and citizen participation.
From Rural to Digital Markets: E-Saras-ONDC partnership Ushers E-commerce Revolution for SHG Enterprises	The Deen Dayal Upadhyay National Rural Livelihoods Mission (DAY-NRLM) launched e-SARAS, a digital marketing initiative to expand market access for Self-Help Groups (SHGs) facing challenges like limited reach, poor quality control, and weak linkages. Through eSARAS.in, SHG women artisans showcased handcrafted products online. To strengthen this effort, NRLM partnered with the Open Network for Digital Commerce (ONDC) to enhance outreach and create stronger forward linkages. However, differences in institutional structures, policy shifts, and SHGs' limited production capacity created challenges. While digital marketing improved visibility and demand, supply-side gaps persisted. The success of e-SARAS now depends on sustained NRLM-ONDC collaboration, capacity building, and stronger supply chain systems to ensure long-term growth and rural women's economic empowerment.
Clearing the Path: Reforming Right of Way for Digital India	This case study explores how the Department of Telecommunications in India addressed critical Right of Way (RoW) issues hindering telecom infrastructure expansion at state level between 2021 and 2023. The Licensed Telecom Service providers and Infrastructure Providers faced significant delays, complex procedures, exorbitant charges, and non-uniform RoW policies across various Indian states. The COVID-19 pandemic intensified the urgency for resolving these issues due to increased reliance on digital connectivity. Strategic interventions included setting up a dedicated National Broadband Mission (NBM) Directorate, consistent stakeholder engagement, periodic review, progress linked escalation, inclusion of RoW in high-level governmental review meetings (e.g. Pragati Review Meetings chaired by the Prime Minister) and digital monitoring via the GatiShakti Sanchar portal. These steps notably reduced application processing times and significantly decreased application pendency.
Reviving Yantra India Limited: Leading Change in India's Defense Public Sector	Yantra India Limited (YIL), formed in 2021 from eight Ordnance Factories, aimed to boost India's defence manufacturing but faced major hurdles in its transition from a government setup to a corporate entity. With limited orders, a ₹1230 million loss, and low employee morale, the company struggled to stay afloat. The end of overtime pay, manpower shortages, and financial strain deepened challenges. YIL secured a small order from Indian Railways and credit from SBI but needed stronger momentum. Its leadership now faces critical choices—whether to expand exports, diversify products, or enhance customer ties—while motivating employees and balancing cost control with welfare to ensure long-term survival.
DBT in Fertilizer Technology	A quiet revolution had taken India by storm and reshaped how the Government of India transferred benefits under its welfare programmes directly to the intended beneficiaries. In India's fertilizer sector, the Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT) system had introduced a more transparent and accountable model for subsidy distribution. Under this system, the government disbursed fertilizer subsidies to companies after the actual sale of subsidized fertilizers to farmers by retailers. Farmers were identified using Aadhaar-based authentication at the point of sale, ensuring that benefits reached the intended recipients while minimizing diversion and lowering administrative costs. view less

Springs of Change: Tackling Water Scarcity in Ziro Valley	This case examines the revitalization of spring water sources and the transformation of a tribal village—Sibbe, situated in Arunachal Pradesh's Ziro Valley—through integrated water resource management, community engagement, and the convergence of government schemes, including the Jal Jeevan Mission (JJM). The protagonist, Smt. Tage Yani, a grassroots leader, mobilizes the community amid ecological stress and water scarcity, ushering in sustainable water governance practices. The narrative documents challenges including deforestation, declining spring flows, community resistance to water tariffs, and lack of technical expertise, and shows how they were overcome through participative planning, spring shed rejuvenation, capacity-building, and institutional innovations such as Village Water & Sanitation Committee (VWSC) empowerment and water pricing models.
Community-Based Forest Fire Prevention and Management in Bandipur Tiger Reserve, Karnataka, India	This case examines the transformation of forest fire management at Bandipur Tiger Reserve (2020–2023) following devastating fires in 2019. The Karnataka Forest Department adopted an innovative community-based model that redefined local communities as conservation partners rather than threats. Addressing challenges such as climate vulnerability, invasive Lantana camara, limited resources, and strained community relations, the initiative combined volunteer fire watchers, early warning systems, indigenous knowledge, livelihood-linked Lantana removal, economic incentives, and capacity building. The results were significant: fire incidents fell by 63%, burned area reduced by 74%, response time dropped sharply, and alternative livelihoods were created for hundreds of families. The case demonstrates that sustainable conservation depends on community participation, shared economic benefits, and integrating local knowledge with modern governance tools.
Restoring Roots of Resilience: Evolution of Seasonal Migrants into Employers	The case study describes the transformation of Kanfodi village in drought-prone Jalna District from distress migration and poverty to a source of local employment within a decade. Before 2018, households relied only on rainfed crops and faced seasonal migration, poor infrastructure, and socio-economic hardship. Intervention by MSRLM through SHG formation and financial literacy led to the introduction of vegetable farming, which became a turning point due to steady income and reliable markets. Innovations like drip irrigation, staggered planting, and market surveys increased productivity and earnings. Distress migration reduced to 20% by 2024-25, living standards improved, and women emerged as key decision-makers. Landless households were supported through poultry, goat rearing, and a daal mill. Despite challenges like water scarcity and institutional gaps, Kanfodi stands as a model of community-led, sustainable rural development. view less
CCTNS - Lessons in Managing Large Technology Projects in Indian Policing System	This case study examines the Crime and Criminal Tracking Network Systems (CCTNS), conceptualised by the Ministry of Home Affairs in 2009 under the National e-Governance Plan to digitally connect all police stations in India, digitise crime records, and enable real-time information sharing and decision-making. While CCTNS aimed to replace fragmented, manual record-keeping with a unified technology-driven system, its initial implementation (CCTNS 1.0) faced significant challenges, including delays, design gaps, and coordination issues across Centre–State and multi-stakeholder arrangements. Despite repeated setbacks, the project was revived with renewed focus. The case highlights the ongoing need for police workflows that resolve criminal identity and enable data analytics—objectives now linked to the upcoming CCTNS 2.0.
Operation of Shramik Special Trains for Migrant Labour amid Covid-19 Crisis	The COVID-19-induced lockdown in March 2020 left millions of migrant labourers stranded in various Indian cities. In a historic response, Indian Railways launched "Shramik Special" trains to facilitate their return to their native places, particularly to Uttar Pradesh, India's most populous state. This massive humanitarian and logistical operation, led by Sanjay Tripathi, DRM/Lucknow and nodal officer from Railways, involved coordination with multiple stakeholders—central and state governments. This case highlights the challenges of planning large-scale transportation during a public health crisis, including compliance with COVID-19 safety protocols, logistical hurdles in catering, transport, and staffing, and communication bottlenecks. It underscores leadership, real-time problem solving, delegation, and use of technology in public administration. The operation saw the successful movement of over 3 million labourers to Uttar Pradesh via 957 trains.